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Organization of the Dictionary

The dictionary is divided into two major sections: in the first, entries are arranged English-to-Skiri, and in the second, they are arranged Skiri-to-English. The English-to-Skiri section appears first since most users will not be Skiri speakers and will presumably use that section more than the Skiri-to-English one. Nevertheless, in order to maximize ease of use of the dictionary for diverse purposes, entries in both sections contain the same information.

General Conventions for Citing Skiri Forms

In both the English-to-Skiri and the Skiri-to-English sections, Skiri entry forms are cited as follows:

- **Verbs.** The entry forms of verbs are uninflected stems that do not occur as independent words. They require inflectional prefixes and suffixes, which then undergo the phonological processes that create well-formed words. Two conventions used in citing verb stems should be noted:

    - Stems that require a preverb—that is, that have one of the preverbs (*ir-/a-*, *ut-*, *uur-*) as an integral part of the stem but are positionally separated from it—are cited with the preverb appearing in parentheses immediately after the stem base form, as in *tii* (*ut*...) 'be tame; be accustomed to'. Even though preverbs are placed after the stem base for citation in entries, the user must remember that in word formation the preverb comes before the stem (that is, in positions 13 and 18; see table 7).

    - There is a small number of verb stems based on Ø (*ut*...) 'to be (in a condition)' and Ø (*ir*...) 'to be one's' that have a zero (or null) base. The preverbs of these stems (here *ut-* and *ir-*) then behave like descriptive verbs in that in non-subordinate forms with singular or dual subjects the vowel of the preverb reduplicates as specified in the Stem-Final Vocalic Reduplication Rule (p. 49). If a subject plural prefix follows the preverb, its vowel reduplicates following the same rule. Thus, in *kutatiiʔi* 'it is mine' (< *ku-* POSS + *ta-* IND.1/2.A + *t-* 1.A + *ir-* POSS.1/2.A + Ø 'be one's' + -Ø PERF), the vowel *i* of the

preverb *ir-* is reduplicated to *iiʔi*; and in *kutatiraaʔat* 'it is ours' (< *ku-* POSS + *ta-* IND.1/2.A + *t-* 1.A + *ir-* POSS.1/2.A + *raak-* 1/2.P + Ø 'to be one's' + -Ø PERF), the vowel *aa* of the subject plural prefix *raak-* is reduplicated to *aaʔa* since it is the last overt constituent in the surface form. (The loss of the *r* of the preverb and change of *k* of the plural prefix to *t* in word-final position are regular phonological processes.)

- **Nouns.** In entries, nouns are given in their independent forms; that is, all nouns that require one of the nominal suffixes (*-uʔ* NOM, *-hiriʔ* INST/LOC, *-kat* LOC, and *-ru* LOC) to occur as an independent word have those suffixes on the entry head-word. For example, the noun *paksuʔ* 'head' always has the nominal suffix *-uʔ* NOM when it occurs as an independent (non-instrumental, non-locative) word; but when it is incorporated into a verb or occurs preceding another morpheme in compounds, the suffix *-uʔ* does not occur, as in the following examples:

  tatpaksiitit 'I nodded' < *ta-* IND.1/2.A + *t-* 1.A + *paks-* 'head' + *iitik* 'nod' + -Ø PERF

  pakskiisuʔ 'skull' < *paks-* 'head' + *kiis-* 'bone' + *-uʔ* NOM

Although most Skiri nouns have an independent form, there is a relatively small set of **dependent noun roots** (N-DEP) that do not have an independent form but only occur preceding another stem in a compound. The entry heads of dependent noun roots are cited with a dash after the stem-final syllable. An example of a dependent noun root and two derived words based on it is the following:

asaa- 'horse; dog' in *asaaki* 'dog' (< *asaa-* + *-kis* DIM), *asaapahat* 'roan horse' (< *asaa-* + *pahat* 'be red'), *asiicapaat* 'mare' (< *asaa-* + *icapaak* 'woman'); cf. independent form *aruusaʔ* 'horse'

- **Locatives.** There are two types of locative elements: those that occur as verb stems and inflect as verbs (locative verbs); and those that occur as locative morphemes in verbal derivation, where they add locative information to a verb root or a derived stem. Locatives that do not occur as independent verb stems but only appear in derived forms are cited with a dash at the end of the form. An example of the latter is the following:

  iis- 'out of sight': *iisat* 'go out of sight, disappear over' (< *iis-* + *at* 'go'); *hirasiisat* 'go out of sight in the lead'

- **Other word classes.** Members of other word classes, such as adverbs, adjectives (which are a subclass of nouns), and numerals are cited in their independent forms.

English-to-Skiri Entries

Figure 1 illustrates a typical English-to-Skiri entry. The **English entry word** (usually a single English term) is given in boldface at the very beginning of the entry (in the sample entry in figure 1, the English entry word is **stop**). Often more than one Skiri word can translate a given English word. Thus, in the sample entry in figure 1, English **stop** corresponds to two different Skiri verbs: *awiʔuusik* (*uur...*) and *cawiirik* (*uur...*). Each alternate Skiri translation begins a separate **Skiri subentry** within the entry. Each subentry has up to three **parts** (numbered I, II, and III in the sample entry in figure 1, and discussed immediately below).

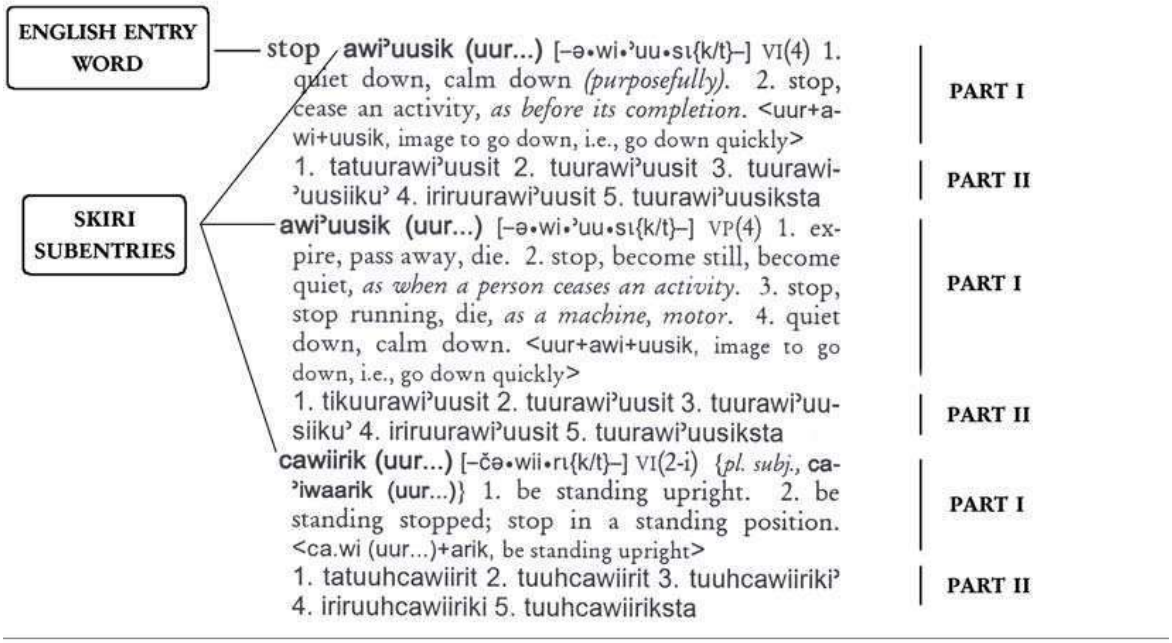

Figure 1. Structure of an English-to-Skiri verb entry

Part I: The first part of a subentry (see fig. 2) comprises basic information that is arranged in the following order:

- **Equivalent Skiri word or stem** that is a translation of the English entry. Like the entry word, it is set off in boldface type (*wiitik* in fig. 2). (See the section "General Conventions for Citing Skiri Forms" above for practices used in representing the equivalent Skiri form—for example, the convention that preverbs required by a stem are cited *after* the stem, as for the preverb *uur-* in the first subentry in figure 1, even though in actual usage they come before it.)

- **Phonetic rendition** of the preceding Skiri term is set off in square brackets and is presented with small bullets marking syllable breaks in the stem or word to assist the user in proper pronunciation.

- **Grammatical class abbreviation** of the entry; that is, one of the abbreviations for what are usually designated parts of speech, such as noun (N), verb (V), and adverb (ADV). These abbreviations are cited in small capital letters (see Abbreviations, p. xiii) that are followed by either a dash for dependent elements or by a verb class based on the subordinate form of a verb (that is, its subordinate suffix or lack of one). Thus in figure 2, *wiitik* is an intransitive verb (VI) of class 4, hence cited as VI (4) (see pp. 32, 45-47 above for discussion of verb classes).

- **Grammatical forms**, if they are irregular or for some other reason require specification, are included in many entries. Such grammatical forms are usually ones for a dual or plural agent or the distributive, and are placed immediately after the grammatical class abbreviation and are enclosed in curly brackets ({ }). The abbreviation for the grammatical form being cited is given first, followed by the Skiri form itself. Thus the Skiri verb in figure 2 has an irregular distributive form *wiiruutik*.

- **Full English gloss** of the preceding Skiri word or stem, often comprising a set of English equivalents that illustrate the semantic range of the Skiri word. Sometimes Skiri words have multiple meanings, and those separate meanings are set off by numbering the glosses. Phrases clarifying usage are frequently added to glosses; these explanatory phrases are italicized since they are not part of the gloss itself (e.g., *as an airplane or a flock of birds* in the fourth gloss of the subentry in fig. 2).

- **The derivation or etymology of a word or stem**, when known, is cited between angled brackets. First the Skiri form is analyzed into its constituent elements. In this analysis, two types of boundaries are indicated: constituent morphemes within a stem are separated by a hyphen (-), and major constituents within the full Skiri form are separated by a plus sign (+). Following the analyzed Skiri form is a literal English translation of the stem or word's underlying meaning. If the underlying morphemic constituency or literal translation has not been determined, no derivation or underlying meaning is given. Sometimes, when relevant, cognate forms that occur in South Band Pawnee (SB), Arikara (Ar.), Kitsai (Ki.), or Wichita (Wi.) are cited.

Part II: The second part of a subentry (fig. 3) is either a set of inflected forms illustrating fully formed verbs that are independent words or, if the entry form itself is a dependent form (noun or locative), a set of derived stems illustrating usage of that dependent form.

- **Inflected forms.** For verbs there are five basic inflected forms (standard verbal paradigmatic forms) that are listed: (1) first person agent (for active, descriptive, and locative verbs) or first person patient (for passive verbs), in the indicative mode, perfective aspect; (2) third person agent or patient, indicative mode, perfective aspect; (3) third person agent, indicative mode, imperfective aspect; (4)

third person agent, gerundial mode (i.e., subordinate absolutive mode), usually perfective aspect; and (5) third person agent, indicative mode, intentive aspect. Certain verb classes do not allow some of these forms and thus are lacking here. Occasionally there is an additional inflected form, set off by a bullet, that illustrates a plural, distributive, or other grammatical form specific to the entry.

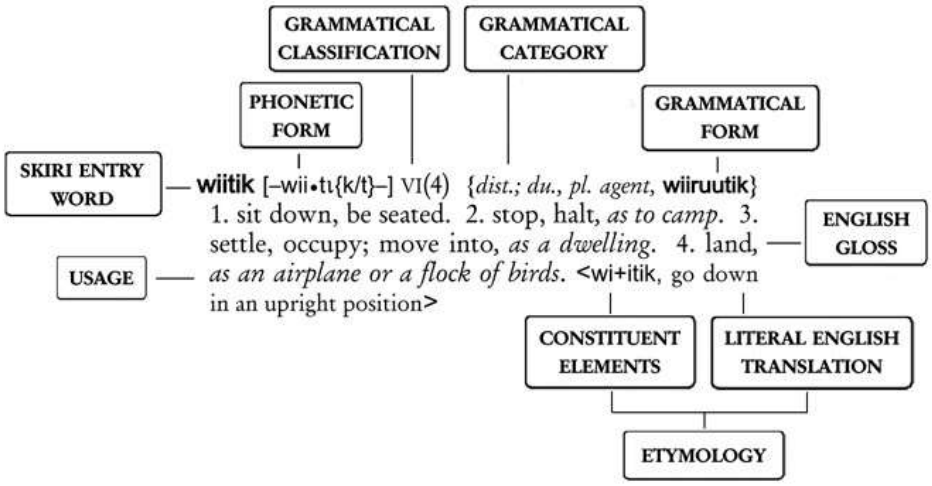

Figure 2. Skiri subentry structure (in a Skiri-to-English entry): Part I, basic information

- **Derived stems.** When the entry head is a dependent form that is not itself subject to inflection but serves as a constituent in deriving new stems, the illustrative forms given are several examples of derived stems that include the dependent entry form.

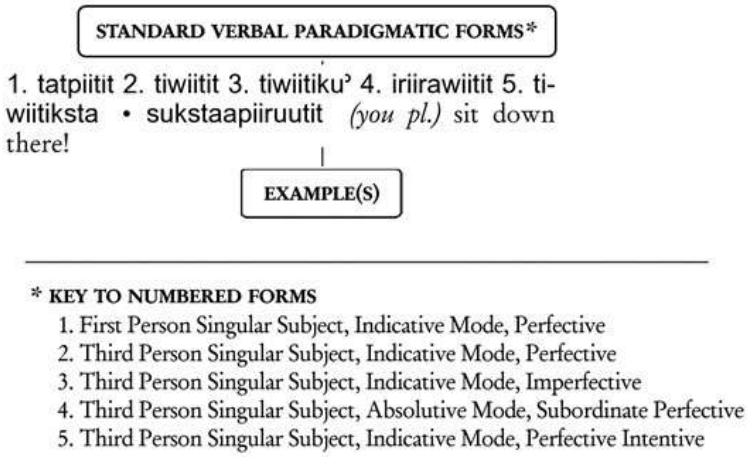

Figure 3. Skiri subentry structure (in a Skiri-to-English entry): Part II, paradigmatic forms and examples

Part III. The third part of subentries (fig. 4) is the citation of one or more cross-references to other, related English words that the user might wish to consult. The structure of these cross-references is the following: they begin with "*see*" and are then followed by relevant English terms that are entry heads, each followed in turn by its Skiri equivalent enclosed in curly brackets. The citation of both English and equivalent Skiri forms enables the user to consult relevant entries in both English and Skiri.

Figure 4. Skiri verb subentry structure (in a Skiri-to-English entry): Part III, cross-references

Skiri-to-English Entries

The structure of entries in the Skiri-to-English section (fig. 5) is essentially the same as that of the English-to-Skiri entries discussed above. However, there are no subentries in the Skiri-to-English section.

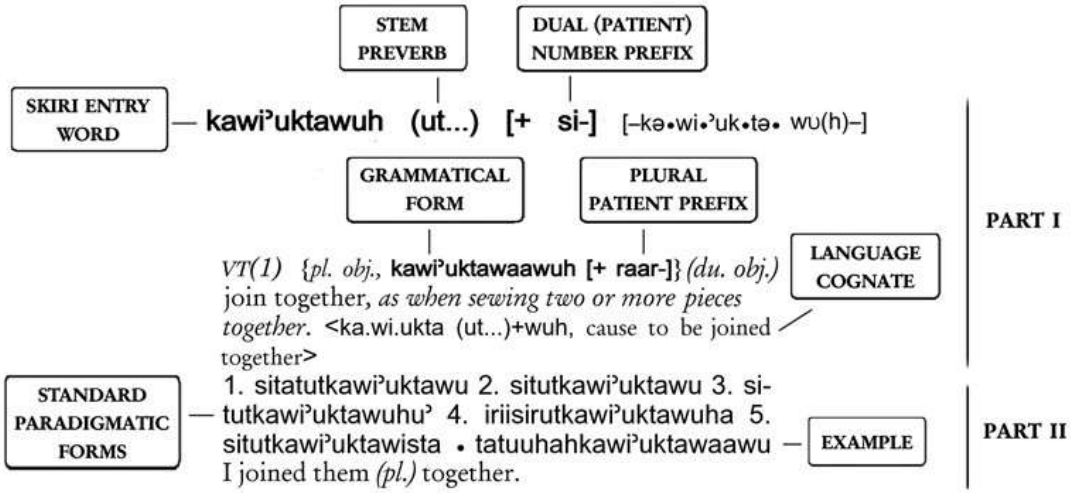

Figure 5. Structure of a Skiri-to-English verb entry

Part I: For verbs, the entry head is a stem or root. Nouns are normally given in their independent form; however, dependent noun stems are cited with a final dash that indicates they require another morpheme or stem following them to form a free noun. Locative verb stems are cited as other verbs are, but dependent locative stems that occur only in derived stems are, like dependent nouns, followed by a stem-final dash. (See the section "General Conventions for Citing Skiri Forms" above for details about how Skiri entry heads are cited.) Following each Skiri entry head is a phonetic rendition enclosed in square brackets. Immediately after the phonetic citation is the word class to to which the head form belongs.

Additional grammatical or phonological information that is specific to a given entry form is provided in curly brackets after the abbreviation for an entry's word class. For verbs, those forms are grammatical. For most noun entries, they are phonologically variant incorporated forms of that noun that appear in derivation.

English glosses of the entry head follow the grammatical information, and after those glosses is the derivation or etymology of the Skiri head word, presented in angled brackets, as described in the English-to-Skiri section above.

Part II: The second part of entries in the Skiri-to-English section contains the same inflected or derived forms that appear as illustrations in entries in the English-to-Skiri section (see above). For verb entries the same five inflected forms are provided, and for dependent nouns and verbal prefixes, examples of derived forms are cited, each separated by a bullet.

Figure 6, in addition to portraying a Skiri-to-English entry, illustrates two features of certain Skiri verb stems that are unusual in structure:

- The entry head has a null verb stem base (i.e., Ø) that has no overt shape in fully inflected non-subordinate verb forms. Since in this example the entry verb stem has a preverb (*ut*...) that is a part of its composition and that preverb appears in all inflected surface forms of the verb, the vowel of the preverb is reduplicated like the final-syllable vowel of descriptive verbs when they are non-subordinate forms. Thus, when the verb stem Ø (*ut*...) has a first person singular agent, the indicative form is *tatuuʔut* (<*ta*- IND + *t*- 1.A + *ut*- PREV), where the vocalic reduplication marks the null stem base.

- The entry head is a compound of the verb Ø (*ut*...) 'to be (in a condition)' and the independent noun *ciksuʔ* 'thought, mind', which has an underlying literal meaning 'to be in a condition of thought(s)' but as a lexical unit translates variously as 'have on one's mind; be thoughtful; be prayerful', etc. Collocations like this one are cited with the verb base preceding the noun, although the noun is free to precede the verb in discourse.

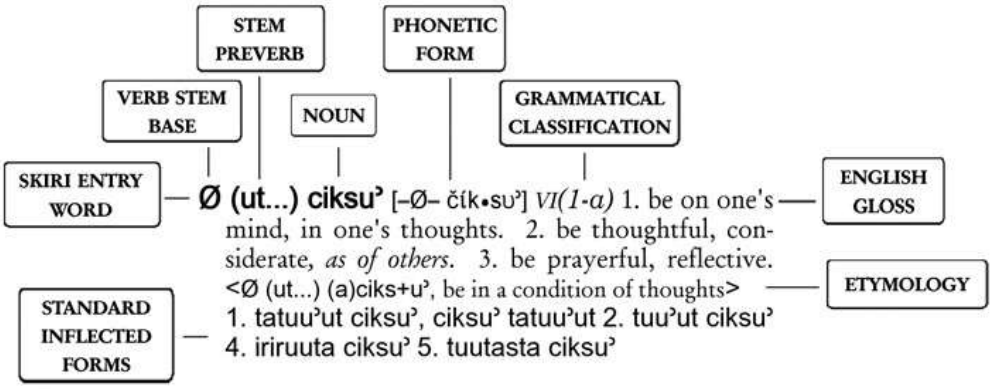

Figure 6. Structure of a Skiri-to-English verb entry illustrating the class of compound stems with the constituents **preverb + null verb stem (Ø) + noun**